

2.6 MMOG

MMOG stands for Massively Multiplayer Online Game. Online gaming has really taken off at present, with broadband Internet becoming a reality for a large number of people. Not only do we have the (usually online) games where a few players take on each other, we now have MMOGs, where thousands of players can be online simultaneously in a simulated environment. The difference between MMOGs and regular online games is that the latter usually have up to 50 players on a single server, which is hosted privately. Also, the action takes place in one out of a number of maps that are provided by the game manufacturer.

MMOGs, on the other hand, have hundreds—sometimes thousands—of players online at the same time. The game publishers themselves provide the servers, and the action takes place in a common environment. The most popular MMOGs are:

- a) **MMORPGs:** MMORPGs (Massively Multi-player Online Role-Playing Games) are the most popular type of MMOGs. They follow the client-server model, where the gamers running the client's software are represented in the online world they inhabit via an avatar. The online world is hosted on a server that is usually owned and setup by the game's publishers. In fact, Most MMORPGs are not free for use—the gamer must buy the game and pay a monthly fee for access-



MMORPGs may look like regular RPGs, but that's where the similarity ends!